Thank you for taking the Decode Your Trauma Assessment, Andy

Please find your report below. You'll also receive an email at sparkyflashrebob@gmail.com with a link to your report.

Your ECHO Profile: The Courageous Explorer

You know your story. Not perfectly, not completely — no one does — but you have been willing to look at yourself honestly, to sit with difficult realisations, to do the inner work that most people avoid. That takes real courage, and it's visible in your results.

What this assessment reveals is someone who has developed genuine insight into how their past has shaped them — and who is also carrying a significant weight of unresolved impact across multiple areas of life. You understand the map. But the territory is still, in meaningful ways, unchanged.

This is one of the most important crossroads on the healing journey, and one of the most honest: the place where you discover that insight, by itself, is not enough to set you free.

Events

Your results reflect a history of significant impact.

You have carried a great deal — and the fact that you are here, willing to look at it honestly, says something important about who you are.

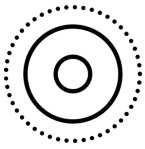
I want to say something directly: the weight you've been carrying is real. It isn't in your imagination, it isn't weakness, and it isn't something you simply need to get over. What you've experienced has had genuine consequences for your nervous system, your relationships, and your sense of self. Acknowledging that isn't wallowing — it's the beginning of a different relationship with your own story. This series will give you the framework to understand not just what happened, but why it landed the way it did, and what it has cost you. That understanding is the first step toward real change.



Safety

Your results identify the core emotional need for Safety as a significant area of deficit in your story.

The nervous system learns its baseline of safety — or lack of it — very early, primarily through the quality of co-regulation with our caregivers. When that co-regulation is inconsistent or absent, the nervous system learns to stay alert, to anticipate threat, to keep one eye always on the exit. In adult life this can show up as chronic anxiety, difficulty trusting others, a pervasive sense of unease even when nothing is wrong, or a body that simply never fully lets go. This is the thread your healing most needs to follow — and it's central to everything this series explores.



Boundaries

Your results also flag the need for Boundaries as significantly unmet

The capacity to hold your ground, say no, and trust yourself to follow through is an important thread running alongside the work ahead.

Homeostasis

Your results suggest a nervous system that is carrying a meaningful level of ongoing activation.

A system that is working harder than it should need to in order to get through ordinary daily life. You may experience this as difficulty truly switching off, a body that stays slightly tense even in safe situations, sleep that doesn't fully restore you, or a sense of being mildly on edge much of the time. This is what I call a maladaptive stress response — a state of chronic activation or shutdown that was once a rational adaptation to your circumstances, but has over time become the system's new normal. What's important to understand is that this isn't just psychological — it is physiological. The significance of this for your healing cannot be overstated: a maladaptive stress response is not just a symptom of trauma. It is the mechanism through which trauma continues to shape your life, day by day. Learning to address it directly is the most important work you can do.

Outcomes

Your results show the ECHO echoing most clearly in the areas of Health and Safety.

I want to reflect something important back to you: these are not character flaws, diagnoses, or evidence of permanent damage. They are the logical, predictable outcomes of a nervous system that has been living in a stress response — and of core emotional needs that were not consistently met. The outcomes are the signal. They are your system communicating, persistently, that something at a deeper

level needs attention. This series begins the work of tracing those outcomes back



Physical Health

The chronic physical health challenges you're navigating are worth taking seriously in this context. The body and the nervous system are not separate systems — they are one. A nervous system living in a chronic stress response has significant downstream effects on immune function, inflammation, energy, and the body's capacity to heal. This doesn't mean your physical symptoms are "just in your head." It means the root system that feeds them may be deeper than physical treatment alone can reach.



Addiction

The patterns you described around using substances or behaviours to manage how you feel are worth understanding clearly: at their root, they are almost always an attempt to regulate a nervous system that has no other reliable way to find equilibrium. This isn't weakness or moral failure. It is resourcefulness in the absence of better tools. What the work of trauma healing offers is precisely those better tools — addressing the nervous system directly, so that the drive to escape it gradually loses its grip.

Next Steps



5-Day Decode Your Trauma Series | April 27 - May 1

Come into this series prepared to be surprised — not by new information necessarily, but by new sequence.

The ECHO model presents the territory you already know in a specific order that has real implications for how healing works. The most valuable thing you can bring to this week is not your existing knowledge, but a genuine willingness to question the order in which you've been approaching your own healing. That question alone has

Alex Howard

Wellbeing Note

This assessment is designed to grow awareness, not to diagnose. If you are currently experiencing significant distress or are in crisis, please reach out to a qualified mental health professional or contact a crisis support line in your country.

Please be aware this is a beta tool for educational purposes, and is not a medical diagnosis, or in any way a replacement for seeing a suitably qualified practitioner. Always seek the advice of your physician or other qualified health provider if you have any questions or underlying medical conditions. Never disregard professional medical advice or delay seeking it because of information presented through this assessment or on our website. If you have any feedback on the tool, please contact hello@alexhoward.com.

Icons made by Three muskateers from www.flaticon.com.